



IIT ROORKEE



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CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 38: Types of Interviews

Part- I

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“The goal of an interview session is to find the right person fit for the job, not just to fill a role.”

— Olawale Daniel



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Understanding Interview

- ❑ Interview as a communicative process proceeds with the plan to collect data from the interviewee/respondent.
- ❑ Data collection is employed in diverse fields, from the job market to journalism and even ethnographic research.
- ❑ The interview process changes according to the needs and context of the interview setup.

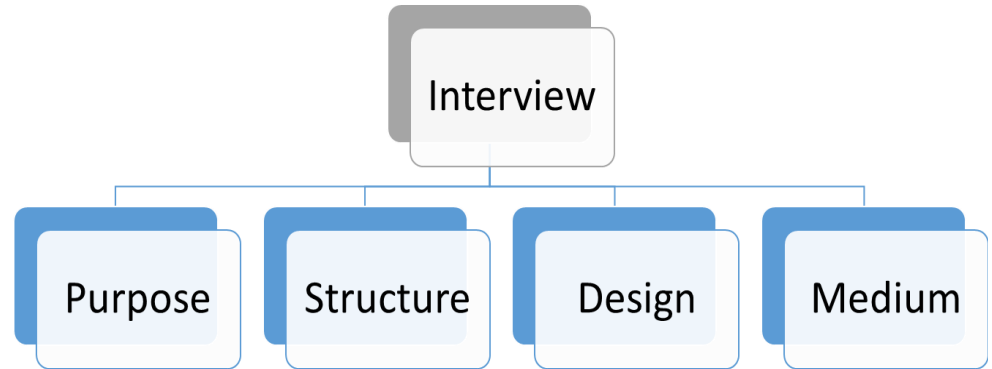


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Categorization of Interviews

Interviews as a data soliciting method could be categorised and studied as various types based on these four criteria, namely:

1. Purpose
2. Structure
3. Design
4. Medium



Types of Interview: Purpose

- The common and ultimate goal of all types of interviews is to collect data for further discussion and analysis.
- Depending on the scenario, the retrieved data will be used to analyse candidates, focus groups, etc.
- The method of conducting and analysing the interview process might vary depending on the interviewer's choice and interest.

Purpose-based Interviews

Job interviews

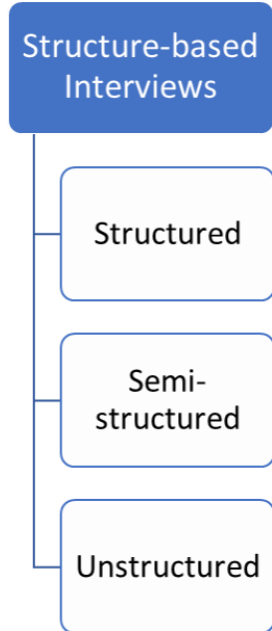
Research Interviews

Clinical Interviews

Journalistic interviews

Types of Interview: Structure

- Structure determines the interview's primary quality (mood, tone, and flow).
- In an interview, the structure is determined by the kind of Q&A exchange employed.
- Interviewer holds the key to governing the direction of the interview.
- Structured interview posits themselves as more rigid when compared to unstructured interview, which is far more flexible.



Structured Interview

- ❖ It follows a standard protocol and pre-established set of questions.
- ❖ The questions asked would remain the same for all the respondents involved.
- ❖ The objective nature of the structured interview makes it less biased.
- ❖ Hiring companies usually prefer structured interviews with specific questions and a prescribed rubric to assess candidates' answers.
- ❖ The one-size-fits-all approach might seem redundant at times.

Unstructured Interview

- ❖ Unstructured interviews employ the opposite style of conducting interviews compared to their structured counterpart.
- ❖ This interview style is known for its spontaneous nature, making the respondents feel more comfortable.
- ❖ Questions are not prepared in advance and thus require a lot of presence of mind from the interviewer.
- ❖ It is usually applied in academic research interviews and focus group studies.



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Semi-structured Interview

- Semi-structured interviews show the dualistic nature of both structured and unstructured.
- It offers both the objective value of a structured interview approach and the subjective quality of an unstructured.
- The trajectory of this interview usually shifts from structured to unstructured after dealing with a few fundamental questions.



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Types of Interview: Design

- The design of the interview signifies the parties involved in the interview.
- The variation in the number of both interviewer and interviewee could be observed.
- The sub-categories include:
 - Individual interview.
 - Panel interview.
 - Group interview.
 - Focus group interview.



Individual Interview

- It is an interrogative session solely devised to be one-on-one between a single interviewer and a single interviewee.
- Individual interview provides more space to discuss in-depth and detail.
- Full attention is offered and received in this interview.
- Enables crafting personalised interview scenarios to suit the needs of the party involved.



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Panel Interview

- ✓ The dynamics of the interview change here with the inclusion of two or more interviewers interrogating one interviewee on the other end.
- ✓ The panel of interviewers might accompany a range of professionals from different levels and backgrounds.
- ✓ Panel interview is handy to check the interviewee on different skill backgrounds.



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Group Interview

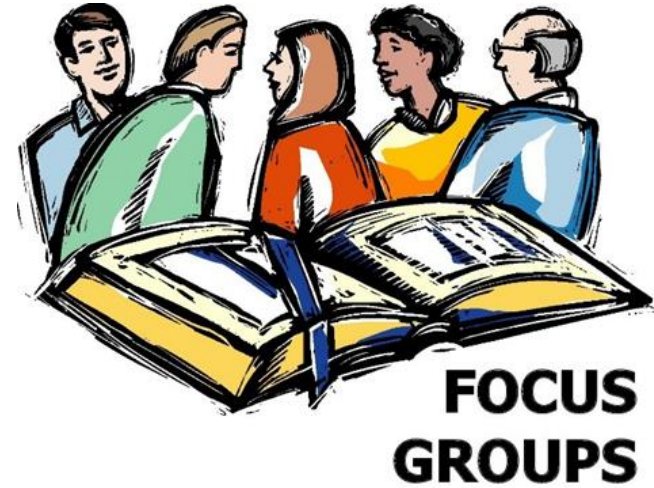
- ❑ Unlike panel interviews, group interviews includes multiple interviewees to be interviewed simultaneously at the same time.
- ❑ It is time-efficient as it allows the interviewer to compare and evaluate multiple participants.
- ❑ Group interviews usually look out for the leadership skills of the candidate.
- ❑ Interviewees compete to present themselves as unique from the rest of the group.



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Focus Group Interview

- The difference between group and focus group interviews lies in the intent.
- While group interviews are usually done for hiring purposes, focus group interview is conducted for market research purposes.
- It is conducted as a qualitative research method to study the preferences and perceptions of a particular group.
- Focus group interviews are comparatively less rigid.



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Focus Group: Laddering Technique

- ❖ It is one of those market research interview techniques which gained popularity in the late 1960s.
- ❖ The laddering technique is a hierarchical way of understanding the market choices of consumers. Consumers are the focus group studied here.
- ❖ It follows the **Means-End Chain theory**, which suggests that people's *attributes* determine their consumer choices (*choices*), reinforcing their *values*.
- ❖ A-C-V sequence forms a chain, or a ladder, that indicates the relationship between product and people.
- ❖ Prof. Michael Hawley suggests this interview method “thrives on [questions like] *why* and *how* the product matters in an individual life.”

“Whenever you are asked if you can do a job, tell 'em, 'Certainly I can!' Then get busy and find out how to do it.” –Theodore Roosevelt

Thank You

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